

MERIDIAN INTELLIGENCE

What it is, where it stands, and how it grows

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WHAT MERIDIAN IS

Meridian is an executive intelligence practice. It takes one high-consequence business decision and returns a written, decision-grade position in days, using seven senior domains run at the same time, with forty years of board-level judgment as the final gate.

You brief it in plain language. It works out every domain the question genuinely touches, runs them **in parallel rather than one after another**, has the work independently checked, and hands back one consolidated answer. Its four jobs: **Classify** the question, **Route** it, **Consolidate** the work, **Return** it with a status and a record of how it was checked.

The seven domains. Commercial and Deal. Legal and Governance, Irish law throughout, the heaviest specialist. Finance and Restructuring. Property and Development. AI Strategy and Adoption. Business Transformation and Growth. AI Equity and Investment. **Four of the seven carry a mandatory human gate:** nothing in Legal, Finance, Property or AI Equity is acted on without a person signing it off.

One job, traced end to end

The brief: "A family builders' merchant in Galway, turnover about four million, second generation coming in, cash is tight. Where do I start?" Meridian routes it to **Finance**, **Business Transformation** and **Legal** at once. The independent critic re-reads the numbers against source before anything moves. One answer comes back: the true cash position, the two fastest value wins, the directors' duties flag while the company is under strain, and the succession conversation that is coming whether or not anyone has raised it. **One brief in. Three domains. One checked, labelled answer out.**

THE FLOOR UNDER EVERY ANSWER — THE PART THAT MATTERS

- **The grounding rule.** No statute, case, figure, title fact or valuation reaches a client unless it was pulled from its primary source and the passage supports it. Anything from memory is never fact. Every hard fact is tagged VERIFIED, REPORTED or UNVERIFIED, and a citation that will not resolve is held, not shipped.
- **The independent critic.** Whatever a skill produces is re-read by a separate agent, on a stronger model, against the original source. The one who makes the work and the one who checks it are never the same, so they do not share a blind spot.
- **A status on everything.** DRAFT, IN REVIEW or DECISION-READY. Only the last can be relied on, and if a piece is not there yet the system says exactly what is missing.
- **Fail closed.** Near a legal, financial or regulatory line, or below 80 per cent confidence, it stops and pulls a person in rather than guess. It cannot quietly grade its own work down to avoid that.
- **The audit record.** Who produced what, from which sources, what the critic found, at what confidence. Every answer can show its own lineage.
- **The boundary.** Meridian informs. It never represents. Anything binding, anything to be signed, filed or relied on, goes to a qualified professional first.

Why this is the asset. A tool that gives an answer is common. A tool that gives an answer **and can show exactly how it reached it, and where it refused to guess**, is rare. The floor is not overhead. The floor is the product.

WHAT CHANGED THIS WEEK

The engine was documented in full for the first time, and then extended. It has gone from **50 skills to 59**.

New capability	Where it sits	What it does
Read-this-for-me	Legal	A contract, lease or term sheet dropped in. Returns what matters, what bites, what to push back on.
Obligations and deadlines	Legal	Every date, statutory clock and filing in a matter, into one schedule with the liability flags on it.
Portfolio conflict check	Legal	Tests a proposed action against existing board seats, shareholdings and mandates, and names any conflict before it arises.
Meeting-prep brief	Commercial	One grounded page before any room: who is being met, their likely position, where the leverage sits, what could go wrong.
What-else scan	Transformation	At the close of any matter, the adjacent work the client now needs next.
Support and grant scan	Transformation	The State supports and funding offsets a client can actually draw on, eligibility checked to source.
Argue-the-other-side	Every answer	Red-teams the recommendation, makes the strongest case against it, names where it would break. Runs unprompted on anything high-stakes.
Say-it-to-the-client	Every answer	Renders any technical output as a clean plain-English page, accuracy intact, sources kept.
Prior-decision recall	Every answer	Checks what was already concluded on a related matter and says so. A silent reversal is treated as a failure.

The last three sit under no single domain. They apply to **every** answer, because a skill wanted everywhere would otherwise only fire when its domain happened to be involved, which is exactly when it is least needed.

Prior-decision recall is the significant one. It turns a body of past work from an archive into an asset. Every engagement now adds a decision precedent the system can retrieve and must reconcile against.

HOW IT GETS BETTER FROM HERE

The engine is extended in plain English, not in code. Adding a capability is a one-line job and it is live immediately, with no rebuild.

1. Say what you want in one plain sentence. 2. Decide which domain already thinks that way. 3. Match the shape of what is already there. 4. Write the line and save. 5. It is live at once. 6. Prove it: point a question at it. 7. Commit it, so it is on the record.

Only the first two steps require judgment. Everything after is mechanical. A new capability **inherits the grounding rule, the independent critic, the status label and the human gate automatically**, simply by living inside the system. The discipline is never re-implemented and never degrades as the engine grows.

The working rule: when the same thing has been done by hand twice, that is the next capability. Both additions made this week came from exactly that. Grant intelligence had appeared unprompted in three separate pieces of client work before anyone thought to make it a skill.